

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paralur

‘Keep MTC buses off Santhanakrishnan Street’

Residents of Santhanakrishnan Street at Nehru Nagar in Chromepet want the practice of parking MTC buses on their narrow street to end

C.R. NARASIMHAN

Residents of Santhanakrishnan Street at Nehru Nagar in Chromepet have been plagued by the problem of MTC buses from the nearby bus depot being parked on their narrow street for a long time. And the issue has been steadily becoming more difficult to deal with as the neighbourhood grew and vehicle ownership increased. Residents find it is a huge challenge now to move about on their private wheels as these parked buses take a huge bite out of this narrow street.

Between 5 a.m. and 8 a.m., outgoing buses line up on this narrow residential road, awaiting drivers. After 9 p.m., returning buses are again left haphazardly



An MTC bus parked at Santhanakrishnan Street at Nehru Nagar in Chromepet.

until another crew moves them into the bus depot. At any given time, around 10 buses can be seen parked on Santhanakrishnan Street. The root cause is a shortage of crew. Temporary drivers operate buses only when they report, and at night, the crew rush off to collect their daily batta, abandoning the buses on the road. Despite clear directions from the Chief Minister's Office against parking on public roads, enforcement remains weak. The impact is felt most by school vans and office-goers forced to navigate around buses.

With four schools nearby, safety is a major concern. Old buses negotiating narrow lanes risk accidents involving children and pedestrians.

Operationally too, the bus depot's location is inefficient. Shifting it to GST Road, where MTC has major depots at Tambaram, Tambaram Sanatorium and Alandur, would improve fuel efficiency and traffic flow. The CM's Cell has already issued directions. Residents now await action. Relocating the depot will restore safety, reduce pollution, and bring peace back to this neighbourhood.

(C.R. Narasimhan is a resident of Chromepet and founder member, SRDF Vivekananda Vidyalaya in Chromepet)

Pedestrians at peril in Peerkankaranai

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

The pedestrian crossing signal on GST Road in Peerkankaranai is of little help. As per the rulebook, motorists on GST Road and those from Perungalathur flyover should stop to let pedestrians cross, but that rarely happens as motorists jump the signal. This is common for those heading towards Irumbuliyur and to the lane connecting to an underpass along Old GST Road

P. Eashwari, a pedestrian, says, "We are unable to cross as the motorists pose a risk to the safety of pedestrians."

Even motorists from Old GST Road are affected. Motorists can take a left turn (when the pedestrian signal has turned green) to

enter GST Road. But motorists on GST Road and those coming from the flyover disrupt traffic, which can cause accidents.

Traffic police personnel do not come to the aid of pedestrians.

R. Veeramani, a pedestrian, says, "Pedestrians run and risk their lives amidst the traffic flow on GST Road and from the flyover to avoid the undisciplined motorists. When the pedestrian signal turns green, motorists do not wait and proceed, even after seeing pedestrians cross the stretch."

At times, pedestrians can cross only GST Road, not the flyover exit lane because motorists from the flyover do not stop after the pedestrian signal turns green. Pedestrians wait and cross after the motorists halt."



Motorists on GST Road's western lane from Otteri navigate when pedestrians cross the stretch. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Athulya
Geriatric Care

AGE HAPPILY, IN THE COMFORT OF YOUR HOME.

The support you seek,
now comes home.

The Home Care Advantage

- Specialised Nurse at Home
- ICU at Home
- Trained attendant
- Physiotherapy & Rehabilitation
- Geriatric vaccinations

And many more
personalised care services

To Know More

98846 39400

www.athulyahomecare.com



Guindy terminal needs escalators

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Commuters want Southern Railway to install escalators at the entry point to Guindy terminal from Anna Salai. Currently, commuters climb a number of steps to reach the platforms.

S. Ayyappan, a commuter, says, "The commuters have to climb two floors and cross more than 80 steps to go to platforms 1 and 2. At Anna Salai entrance, commuters rush up the steps to board the trains, especially when they see them pull into the station. There is plenty of space for facilitating escalators."

The station has the potential to become the fourth terminal,

as many passengers book tickets at the ticket counters to board long-distance trains.

"At present, a lift connects long-distance trains platforms, but it is yet to be operational. Two escalators connecting the present and yet-to-be-opened footbridge can be facilitated. The yet-to-be-opened bridge should have an entrance along Race Course Road. If an opening is facilitated, there would be diversion of metro and suburban train commuters. Here too, the option of installing escalators should be looked into," says T. Manoharan, a commuter.

The escalators (along Anna Salai) will be useful for long-distance train passengers from Chennai Central and Tambaram railway stations.



Commuters have to climb two floors to access the walkway at the footbridge at Guindy terminal. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Yoga classes in Velachery, Madambakkam

Satyananda Yoga Centre is conducting a four-week Yoga programme from August 3. According to a press release, no fee will be charged. The centre follows the curriculum and tradition of Bihar School of Yoga. Recitation of mantras and sessions on food habits and moral values are part of the course, adds the release. Classes will be held in Mambakkam, Madambakkam, Nanganallur, K.K.Nagar and Velachery. Time: From 5.30 a.m. to 7 a.m.

For venue and other details, call 9382577264 / 9500054370 / 9176902929 / 9841227709 / 6383008358 / 8754499334.

Clear encroachments from service lane

Federation of Radial Road Residents' Associations flags key civic concerns



The Federation of Radial Road Residents' Associations (FORRRRA) has urged the government to clear encroachments from the service lanes along the Radial Road to ensure the safe and unhindered movement of pedestrians.

At its core committee meeting held recently, FORRRRA discussed several civic issues raised by residents. Members (in picture) expressed concern over vehicles being parked on service lanes and called for stricter enforcement to prevent illegal parking and encroachments.

The committee also empha-

sised the need to conserve several waterbodies along the corridor, pointing out that many of them are repeatedly choked with water hyacinth. It urged authorities to undertake regular desilting and removal of the invasive weed to restore and protect these waterbodies.

Another issue highlighted at the meeting was the location of a liquor outlet near apartments.

Residents expressed concern over the inconvenience and safety issues arising from its proximity to homes, and FORRRRA urged the government to relocate the wine shop to another place.

'Restore the inlet channel to Chitlapakkam lake'

M. RAVI

Instead of restoring the inlet rainwater channel of Chitlapakkam Lake, the Water Resources Department has beautified the structures on the water-holding area of the waterbody.

This illogical move, along with last year's deficient monsoon, has depleted groundwater, and the lake has not reached its full storage level.

The lake has dried up in some areas. With the government funding the restoration of a few waterbodies, residents feel that the necessary work to restore this waterbody could have been carried out.

The work includes desilting and deepening of lake beds, preventing sewage flow, and restoring rainwater inlets.

But the Department failed to restore the rainwater inlet channel from Pachaimalai and focused on building structures in the water-holding area.

Social activists and long-time residents, P. Viswanathan, S



Chandrasekaran, and I gave petitions to the Department to restore the channel; the WRD replied that the channel comes under the Revenue Department. A Revenue Department officer came and inspected the channel and submitted a report, but the necessary action has not been taken.

The channel should be restored to supply herbal water to the lakes of Chitlapakkam, Sem-

bakkam, Nanmangalam, Keezhkattalai, and Narayanapuram, before it culminates in the Pallikaranai marshland.

The work does not end with the restoration of lakes. At regular intervals, cleanliness and maintenance work should be carried out.

M. Ravi is the secretary of Sri Sarvamangala Nagar Residents' Association, Chitlapakkam

Special train to Tenkasi from Tambaram

The Southern Railway will operate special trains from Tambaram to Tenkasi to clear the extra rush of passengers.

Train Number: 06135, Tambaram - Tenkasi Bi-weekly Superfast

Special will depart at 5 a.m., and reach Tenkasi at 15.30 p.m..

The train is operated on July 30 and August 01, 06, 08, 13th and 15th (Thursdays and Saturdays).

Train Number: 06136, Tenkasi

- Tambaram Bi-weekly Superfast Special will depart at 5 a.m., and reach Tambaram at 15.15 p.m..

The train is operated on July 31 and August 02, 07, 09, 14th and 16th (Fridays and Sundays).

The trains will stop at Chengalpattu, Villupuram, and Tiruchirappalli.

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.

A wish list of bus routes from Velachery

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

On June 27, commuters from 100 Feet Road in Velachery submitted a petition to the Metropolitan Transport Corporation to improve bus services between the region and Royapuram. R. Palanivel, a commuter, says, "Many years ago, there were a good number of services connecting Broadway and Thiruvottiyur from Sithalapakkam, Ottiyambakkam, Medavakkam, Tambaram (East), Madambakkam and Velachery through Vijaya Nagar bus terminus. Today, the services are as good as non-existent, as only a few ply in the morning and are not sighted in the evening."

I. Rajasekaran, a bus commuter,



Bus terminus in Vijaya Nagar. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

stated that as a result, commuters from Velachery have to come to Little Mount to board buses to destinations along Mount Road and Royapuram. To reach Thiruvottiyur, commuters have to disembark at the Chennai Central railway station bus stop or at the Royapuram terminus and board another bus.

Routes needed

* Route D51 (Sithalapakkam to Royapuram) is available only once a day in the morning at the Vijaya Nagar bus terminus. Three additional services should be introduced to cater to the morning and evening rush.

* E51 (Ottiyambakkam to Royapuram) can be spotted at 7 a.m. at the terminus. A bus should start from the terminus between 8.15

and 8.20 a.m., followed by additional services.

* 51J (Medavakkam Koot Road to Royapuram) makes one trip in the morning. A bus should start from the terminus at 8.30 a.m. for the benefit of office-goers. There are no services of the route numbers in the evenings, the petition stated.

51D (Tambaram (East) - Royapuram) is operated to the Secretariat in the morning. Another service on the same route number to Royapuram via Anna Salai should be operated. Additional bus services should be operated during rush hour in the mornings and evenings on both routes.

Transport corporation officials said the demands have been sent to the officers concerned for appropriate action.

Rallying for *our* wetlands



Images from the protest march. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

C. NAMACHIVAYAM

A staggeringly huge number of organisations united by their interest in conservation of natural habitats organised a protest march at Besant Nagar Beach on July 25, highlighting the destruction of wetlands in south Chennai.

One of the salient features of the march was the eye-catching props used by the protestors. The props included a life-size representation of a flamingo demanding that people stay off its turf.

Others included images of fish that people were wearing while holding placards.

The organisations that participated in the protest march are: Alliance of Residents Welfare Associations; Agai, The Theater of Voices; Chennai Climate Action Group;

Chennai Wetlands Action Collective; Center for Financial Ac-



countability; Chitlapakkam Rising Team; Foundation for Friendly Environment and Medical Awareness; Federation of Perumbakkam Resident Welfare Associations; Federation of Old Mahabalipuram Road Resident Associations; Friday For Future Chennai; Palluyir Trust; Ramapuram - Youth Climate Resilience

Movement; Reached the Unreached; Saving Nanmangalam Lake Team; Singaravelar Padipagam; SPARK; Suzhal Arivom; Tambaram Makkal Kuzhu; Uvakai Research Foundation; Vettiver Collective; Visai; Vinna Naadaga Kuzhu; Vyasarpadi - Youth Climate Resilient Movement; and Zenith Learning Center.

HCL Foundation equips students with new-age tech skills

HCL Foundation and HCL GUVI, an educational technology company, celebrated the completion of the HCL Foundation AI Program, an industry-aligned skilling initiative that trained 1,070 students.

Held at IIT Madras, the felicitation ceremony brought together students, faculty, and industry partners to celebrate the culmination of a four-week programme designed to bridge the gap between classroom learning and industry-ready AI capabilities.

The programme combines AI fundamentals, Python programming, practical assignments, assessments, mini-projects, and technical interview preparation to equip students with both technical skills and job readiness, a press release stated. Of the 1,070 students who completed the programme, more than 700 students took the placement eligibility assessment.

For details, log on to <https://www.guvi.in/> Phone: 97360 97320.

**ANUGRAHAM**
SMART HOMES
Beautiful Spaces Trusted Solutions
WE DESIGN. WE BUILD. WE DELIVER EXCELLENCE.
OUR SERVICES

- **INTERIOR DESIGN**
Creative • Functional • Elegant
- **CIVIL & RENOVATION**
Quality • Strength • Reliability
- **ELECTRICAL WORKS**
Safe • Efficient • Certified
- **CCTV & SECURITY SYSTEMS**
Secure • Smart • 24/7 Protection
- **SMART HOME SOLUTIONS**
Automate • Simplify • Enhance

8861895225
Chennai & Surroundings
anugrahamsmarthomes@gmail.com
LET'S CREATE SPACES YOU'LL LOVE.

Metro Rail work on major corridors in Mylapore has cast a shadow on C.P. Koil Street with its goldsmiths, and here is how these traditional craftspersons are ensuring the sparkle is not lost despite poor access to their doorsteps

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Chengazhuneer Pillaiyar Koil Street off North Mada Street in Mylapore can be missed by footwear-clad hooves other than those heading to it aware of what it has to offer, a standout craftsmanship nestling quietly inside. Narrow and hemmed in by non-decrepit buildings, it slips past the eye unless one has known it for what it is: the bling street in these parts. In terms of numbers, both of shops and transactions, C.P. Koil Street is no patch on Edapalayam Street, which winds like a necklace between NSC Bose Road in George Town and Walltax Road in Park Town. While Edapalayam Street is the undisputed capital for gold and other precious metal jewellery-making and testing in Chennai, C.P. Koil Street could be placed in a “family” that includes gold jewellery-making enclaves in T. Nagar and Purasawalkam.

The description of a lane fitting it better than that of a street, C.P. Koil Street (the quickly recognised contraction) is lined with shops of gold-and-other-precious-metal jewellery-making craftspersons strategically interspersed with those selling jewellery. There are flower vendors, and shops selling temple-related items at C.P. Koil Street sketching the classic image of a street running close to a famous temple (in this case, Kapaleeswarar temple), but the one trait that overrides everything else is that of a turf for craftspersons adept at shaping precious metal into wearables. These craftspersons, some of whom also work with silver and zari saris that have gold and silver threads woven into them, draw upon the trust built patiently over generations. At Santhosh Thanga Maligai, the owner M. Padmanabhan is carrying forward a family business that had its genesis on North Mada Street where his grandfather operated for nearly 50 years. In its current location at C.P. Koil Street, the business has weathered 40 summers. And if one does a simple addition math, there is an unmistakable and majestic hoariness to the enterprise. This account of a skill passed down generations is a recurring feature, the story reappearing at different addresses across C.P. Koil Street’s storefront.

A bling street behind barricades

This business cannot get any more family-oriented than it is. It could not be put more lucidly than how Karthik Gopal of Sagunthala Testing on C.P. Koil Street does. “It is a family business started by my grandfather Venkatesh,” and on who has been running it now, Karthik rattles off a list: “My father, me, my uncle, my aunt, my mother, my cousins, my niece... everyone” And that certainly is pretty much everyone in the family.

Just as craftsmanship and ownership are passed down the generations, on the other side of the counter, customer loyalty also follows an unbroken line of continuity, generations of a family getting gold jewellery done at a shop

whose work ethics they trust. This trust is coming in handy as these craftspersons are battling challenges arising from a mammoth civic work just beyond C.P. Koil Street’s doorsteps.

Finding itself in the long shadows of Metro rail work all around it, C.P. Koil Street might be a little less hoofed now, but the adverse situation has not significantly detracted from its glitter. The trust factor carries the day for these craftspersons as floating customers have dwindled on account of access unwittingly restricted by Metro rail work on main corridors in Mylapore, examples being Kutchery Road, Luz Church Road and RK Mutt Road.

“Now, almost all roads leading to the street have been affected by Metro rail work. Our regular customers still return because they know us,” says Karthik, noting that accessibility as a whole has been a difficult hurdle to bypass. Years of dedication and craftsmanship have earned them a loyal customer base. However, reputation alone cannot replace the steady stream of first-time visitors the place once enjoyed. “Seven years ago, there was much more footfall,” Karthik recalls. Being overly dependent on your established customer base with little scope for new customers swelling it can bring about a frustrating clinginess and a tendency to want to play Aladdin’s servile genie to those loyal customers from the past. Padmanabhan says his shop is open all days of the week, from 10.30 a.m. to 8.30 p.m.; and they close for work only on two festival days in a year. This challenge plonks alongside others faced by all goldsmiths, particularly those in south India, in Karthik’s view. While technology would have brought a cutting edge of accuracy and speed to the goldsmith’s job, Karthik notes, customers still prefer the sight of a goldsmith seated in front of them and testing and assessing the precious

In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at how a narrow, hidden street associated with a form of time-tested craftsmanship is holding on to its legacy against the backdrop of a civic work that has disrupted commerce in the region

metal. It is down to trust issues, he points out. Laser technology makes jewellery-making swift, but too many people cannot be allowed to stay around lest there could be spread of dust. Those who work with this technology are in the right gear for it. The challenge lies in making the process effective through technology and at the same time making it reassuringly visible for the customer.

A picture of sameness

“The street has not changed much,” says Karthik. Padmanabhan echoes that sentiment in a tone that rings wistful. “There has been no development. The street remains the same, and its narrowness leaves little scope for change,” says Padmanabhan. And perhaps that is what makes the present struggle so striking and relevant. The businesses remain where they started and the community they created continues to seek them. It is the journey moving forward that has become increasingly difficult for them. Preserving the place’s commercial character also means preserving the ease with which people, the outsiders, can be a part of it. And at present, that is a challenge.



A small number of apartment communities in Chennai now offer an impressive 1:1 EV charger-to-parking ratio thanks to developers future-focussed in their thinking. Even these developers admit they are on a learning curve, trying to grapple with technology to make their offering even more meaningful

Towards a fully 'charged up' parking space

LIFFY THOMAS

When a large apartment complex goes big on EV adoption, providing a dedicated charging point at every parking slot, the move will have far-reaching benefits. For one, it would give impetus to the Tamil Nadu government's October 2025 mandate requiring charging point for every individual car and two-wheeler parking space in residential buildings.

Here are two builders who saw the need for personalised charging points even before the State Government came up with this mandate.

In 2022-23, Radiance Group announced launch of the 234-unit Radiance Majestic in Valasaravakkam with one feature embossed: a one-to-one charger to parking ratio. Eight months ago when residents started occupying the flats, they were happy the builder had made good the promise.

The apartment complex has 10-15 EV owners who make the most of the single phase EV charging point that

delivers 7.4 kW of power when connected to their individual meter. This infrastructure is likely to get more residents to switch to an EV.

The builder is modest to admit they still have some ground to cover.

"We were inspired by projects in Pune and Mumbai to adopt the same in Chennai, but we are still learning as those owning a high end car want a fast charger but we have only provided a neutral charger. As this technology is still evolving, there is a lot that we need to analyse and factor in as more owners bring home an EV," says Gnana Murugan of Radiance Group.

With individual EV plug point at every parking spot, Lancor Infynys, a 290-flat gated community in Keelakattalai has a story of how the teething trouble was overcome. The irritants, which

included lack of output from the charging point, app not getting connected and iPhone not getting synced, were addressed over a period of time. "With technology do expect some issues but it is extremely easy and convenient to charge at your convenience from your own space," says Vinoth Kumar, who owns an electric two-wheeler.

He shifted from a large apartment complex in Pallikaranai to Keelakattalai a year ago to avail this facility. "My previous apartment did not have even a common charging point, so I used to go to public charging stations or borrow from other EV owners who had connected it from their power box," says Vinoth.

Those working in the EV charging network say it is way easier for an upcoming project to provide owners with the basic infrastructure at their parking lot by focusing on proper earthing and electric load capacity than initiating the work in existing apartments.

Nethaji M, senior manager, charging infrastructure at Bolt.Earth, an EV charging network, says all that we ask developers is provide the cabling work by connecting every parking lot

with the resident's individual meter. The charging kit varies from vehicle to vehicle and is provided when the person buys

the EV which can be fitted to the plug point.

"3.3 kW is the basic requirement that we recommend for an individual parking lot, but as the number of EV users increases in a community the extra load must also be planned by coordinating with the Tamil Nadu Electricity Board," says Nethaji.

CREDAI's stand

Confederation of Real Estate Developers Association of India - Chennai had represented to the Additional Chief Secretary, Housing and Urban Development Department, Government of Tamil Nadu that one-to-one charger-to-parking ratio may be "technically unnecessary, financially burdensome, and operationally impractical, especially in large residential developments."

Currently, 7 kW AC home charger has been used as the ba-

sis for EVs priced below ₹20 lakh. With the market fast moving towards 11 kW AC chargers, transitioning from 7 kW to 11 kW would reduce charging times by nearly 35%, sharply improving utilisation efficiency. If 11 kW becomes the norm, the current requirement of having a dedicated charger for every parking slot would result in an overcapacity, nearly 18 times higher, rendering the infrastructure severely underutilised, says CREDAI in their representation. Developers feel rapid technological advancements will outdate today's chargers. EV charging cables, often 30-40 mm in diameter, pose major challenges when routing hundreds of lines across basements and high-rise structures. The cumulative cable volume, ducting requirements, and heat considerations make one-to-one provisioning technically unviable.

A green upgrade, slow and steady

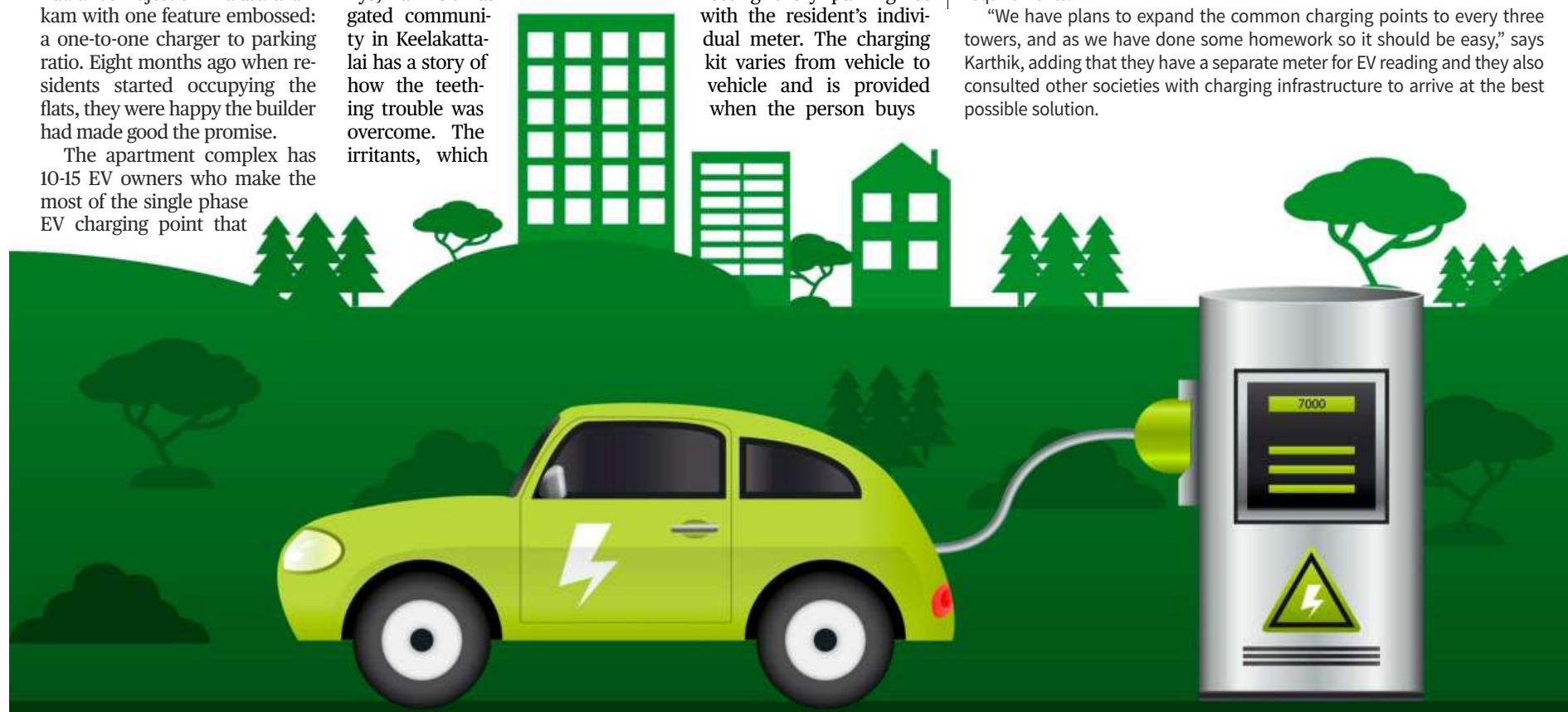
Most older gated communities are not keen on a one-to-one charger to parking ratio for a variety of reasons and are taking baby steps towards increasing the common EV infrastructure.

Brentwood, one of the 13 towers at House of Hiranandani in Egattur, was the first to invest in an EV charging station that was opened to residents from other towers as well. Now, they have another tower, Amalfi, that has also opened a charging station just for cars.

Likewise, DLF Gardencity Cluster 1 in Semmancherry invested in four basic charging devices to meet the needs of both two-and-four wheelers. The infrastructure was installed at a place easily accessible to residents from the nine towers at DLF Gardencity. This year, the Association upgraded the amenity with four charging points for two-wheelers and four others for four-wheelers.

Karthik T.S., a committee member, says their EV journey has been "steady and fruitful". Towards finding out what best suits the needs of the community, they took up a study that included finding out how many vehicles were coming to the community, how quickly the vehicles were getting charged, the EV capacity, the charger that should be used, how many charging stations are there around the campus and the power requirements.

"We have plans to expand the common charging points to every three towers, and as we have done some homework so it should be easy," says Karthik, adding that they have a separate meter for EV reading and they also consulted other societies with charging infrastructure to arrive at the best possible solution.





During a workshop at a college in Thiruverkadu. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Art against drugs

Fevicryl-certified teachers fan out to educational institutions to create awareness about drug abuse and fight the scourge

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

A city-wide campaign through art is mobilising students at colleges and schools to speak up about the dangers of substance abuse. Initiated by art and craft brand Fevicryl, the initiative launched recently has Fevicryl-certified teachers visiting institutions to conduct an art session where students use their creativity to create meaningful works on the theme of drug awareness. The sessions are aimed at encouraging creativity, building teamwork, promoting social responsibility and

creating awareness for a drug-free society.

Tejaswitha Singh, a resident of Adyar who is driving the initiative in south Chennai, says, "All what we ask institutions is give them two hours and at least 200 students and we engage with them to use art to create awareness." The materials for the artworks have to be arranged by the students that includes canvas board, markers and other stationery.

A team of three would be assigned to every institution where they are also involved in colouring a 6ft x 3 ft banner with colourful messages.

Besides being a Fevicryl certified trainer, Tejaswitha works as a guest lecturer in fashion designing. She says there are close to 150 such certified teachers in Chennai and they are fanning out to institutions in their respective areas to increase participation in this initiative.

By researching about drugs and its side effects to send out a message on canvas, the initiative nudges students to recognise behavioural signs and be allies with the State Government in combating the scourge of drug abuse.

If you wish to invite the team, contact Tejaswitha Singh at 80560 91498



A brush with acrylic painting

T. ARVIND

At 11, Hannah Maria Pradeep, a Class VI student of Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram in Kilpauk, is pursuing acrylic painting and portraiture while developing her artistic practice through formal training, exhibitions and participation in national and international art platforms. She is currently training at Dessin Academy partnered with The Tamil Nadu Dr. J. Jayalalitha Music and Fine Arts University, where she is learning acrylic and oil painting, portrait drawing, pencil sketching and pen sketching.

Artistic roots

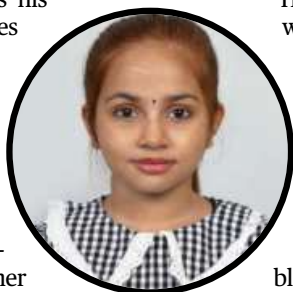
Her interest in art has been influenced by her late grandfather, Jerome Augustes Thomas, a classical artist known for his acrylic and oil paintings during the 1980s and 1990s. Although she did not have the opportunity to learn from him

A student of Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram is honing her skills in acrylic painting while drawing inspiration from a family legacy in art



directly, Hannah says his body of work continues to inspire her approach to painting. "Whenever I pick up a brush, I feel as though he is guiding my hand," says Hannah.

Acrylic is her preferred choice. One of her recent works, *The Last Whisper of the Forest*, depicts a young deer and reflects themes of wildlife conservation and environmental awareness.



Hannah's paintings were exhibited at *Colourful Expressions 2025*, the annual exhibition organised by Dessin Academy, where works by students were displayed before members of the public and the art community.

She also secured the first place in the Upper Primary category of A Virtual Cultural Extravaganza, organised by I2OR India in collabora-



Hannah Maria Pradeep's works in acrylic. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

theme India Through My Eyes, which focussed on India's cultural heritage and environmental consciousness.

She is also a member of the Children's Art Museum of India and is currently participating in The Giant Hunt, an all-India anime competition associated with a Guinness World Record attempt involving thousands of young participants.

Asked about her artistic journey, Hannah Maria Pradeep said: "I believe every child is born with a special gift. Mine is art. I am thankful to my parents and teachers for encouraging me to pursue my passion and helping me develop my skills."

Hannah's mother, Swetha Margaret, an educationist, said encouraging her daughter to pursue art has helped her develop interests beyond academics. "Her interest in art has complemented her academic performance. While education is important, parents should also identify their children's talents and support them in pursuing their interests."

tion with Green ThinkerZ India. In another achievement, she was selected as a Star Artist in Artistic Genesis 2026, an international art event that drew entries from more than 1,200 artists representing 61 countries. According to the organisers, the entries were assessed by an international jury comprising artists from Canada, Egypt and India.

Hannah has participated in The Indian Art Fest, an international platform for young artists, and contributed artwork to the Art for Awareness campaign under the

HGI starts school in Padappai



The Hindustan Group of Institutions (HGI) has established Hindustan International School (HIS) in Padappai to provide a contemporary learning environment that integrates academic excellence, technology, creativity, sports, and va-

lues-based education.

Theodosius Mar Thoma, Metropolitan, Malankara Mar Thoma Syrian Church, inaugurated the campus.

In his speech, he underscored the importance of education rooted in values, character, and compassion in

shaping responsible global citizens.

Anand Jacob Verghese, chairman of Hindustan Group of Institutions, said, "We believe education must go beyond academic achievement to nurture character, creativity, critical thinking and a sense of purpose. Through this campus, we aim to create an environment where every learner is encouraged to explore their potential, embrace innovation and grow into a responsible global citizen while remaining rooted in strong values."

The campus features smart classrooms, robotics and computer laboratories, composite science laboratories, innovation and maker spaces, and dedicated sports infrastructure.

Two books were released: one curated by Anand Jacob, 'Journey of Parables', a collection of reflections centred on leadership and values, and a coffee table book, 'Historia', documenting the decade-long journey of Hindustan International School, a release from HGI stated.

Course on Montessori teacher training

The Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC), Chennai, will commence their 57th Montessori teacher training Course in August.

The weekend course will have online and in-person sessions, a format designed to suit working women, enabling them to balance work and family while pursuing their passion for early childhood education.

IMTC-Chennai is affiliated with the Indian Montessori Center, Bengaluru, which awards the Di-

ploma to successful candidates.

Over the past three decades, IMTC, Chennai, has quietly supported Tamil Nadu's early-education landscape.

IMTC-Chennai has trained more than 1700 teachers, and over 45 schools in Tamil Nadu have been established by the institution's alumni.

For details, WhatsApp and call 94449 36263, 044-24614301.

Email: admissions.imtcc@gmail.com
Visit: <https://imtccennai.org>



Inviting married women for 'Face of Chennai'

Registrations have opened for the 15th edition of IRIS Face of Chennai - Mrs Category. Married women up to the age of 50 years from diverse backgrounds can participate to showcase their personality, talents, and unique journeys. Participants will gain access to expert mentoring, grooming and presentation training, networking opportunities, exciting gifts, and a platform to enhance their confidence and skills.

To register for auditions, contact 98847 83510, 98412 06506



The team. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

DG Vaishnav College wins basketball title

The Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College (Autonomous) won the 29th Sree Raghavendra Inter-Collegiate Basketball Championship, held in the city from July 11 to 23.

In the knockout match, the college defeated Jeppiaar University, 72-47; in league matches, SRM University, 67-56; Hindustan University, 71-69; and Madras Christian College, 91-51.

The team showed outstanding teamwork, which paved the way for an unbeaten run in the tournament and helped them to clinch the title and bring pride to the institution.

The results: Hindustan University, runner-up; SRM University, third place; and Madras Christian College, fourth place, said a release.



BUYING BEST PRICE

Very Old Rosewood, Teakwood
Antique Furniture, Antique Watches
Wooden Art, Brass Art, Paintings
Kolu Toys, Silk Saree, Old Coins
Antique Pen, Clock, Vintage items
All Rare Collectibles

98408 20587

KP SAMY
INTERIOR & EXTERIOR

Residential & Commercial

Terrace Leakage	Electrical
Tank Water Proofing	Painting
Bathroom Water Proofing	Plumbing
Weathering Course	Flooring & Wall Tiling

9884591 295

MARUTI SUZUKI ARENA
For Service Booking Call

AUTO TECH

Ph : 97100 11888
044 - 223 88888

No.6, 1st Street,
Kamatchi Colony,
Sanatorium,
Chennai 600 047.

K R CONSTRUCTIONS
BUILDING CONTRACTOR & ENGINEER

BUILDING CONSTRUCTION @ 2350/- SQ.FT.
INCLUDING OHT & ELEVATION WORKS

*BUILDING DEMOLITION
*LABOUR CONTRACT

→ ARCHITECTURAL PLANS
→ ENGINEER SUPERVISION
→ BRANDED MATERIALS

8072 499969

SIVAN TRADER E-WASTE

AC 1 1/2	1.5 1/2	2 1/2
₹4000	₹5500	₹6500

Stainless Steel 1Kg ₹50
Aluminium 1Kg ₹240
Brass 1Kg ₹700
Copper 1Kg ₹1000
Water Heater
Home Theatre
Music System
Computer Laptop
All A-Z E Waste

INVERTER BATTERIES Any Condition ₹3500/-

SPOT CASH BEST PRICE GUARANTEED

All A-Z E Waste கட்டிடக்கலை, கட்டுமானம், கட்டுமானம்
Call: **97108 20853**

KALAIIVANI OLD AGE HOME @ EAST TAMBARAM

Contact: 98843 67968 89392 76861

MATHWAY ACADEMY NANGANALLUR
MATHS TUITION CENTRE

Class 8-12
Engineering (M1,M2,M3,M4)
100% SUCCESS GUARANTEED!

Contact: J.THIVAGARAJAN 91766 77726

No.121, Nehru High Road, Teachers Colony, Nanganallur - 61.

To advertise in DOWNTOWN

Contact: UDHAYAKUMAR 81246 14787



HOUSE OF L.K.S

LKS

GH

SINCE 1925

LKS

GOLD HOUSE

SINCE 1925

Make This

Aadi

A Golden One

₹ ————— 3

V.A. ~~25%~~

12.5%

FLAT

50

OFF ON

V.A.

ON ALL JEWELLERY

Attakasa

அடி

Kondattam

 044 2434 1111 | 044 2241 3333    /lksgoldhouse

T. NAGAR | TAMBARAM

60, Usman Road, T. Nagar, Chennai - 600 017 | 80/81, G.S.T Road, Tambaram, Chennai - 600 045